

Tenant Handbook

Property management policies - for demo purposes only

1. Welcome

This handbook outlines the policies, responsibilities, and expectations that apply to all tenants in properties managed by this firm. Please retain a copy for reference for the duration of your lease.

2. Rent, Due Dates, and Payment Methods

Rent is due on the 1st of each month. The grace period runs through the 5th. Payments received after the 5th incur a late fee equal to 5% of the monthly rent. Accepted payment methods are ACH bank transfer, personal check, certified check, and credit card. Cash payments are not accepted at any property. Returned-check fees are \$35 per occurrence.

3. Security Deposits

The security deposit is equal to one month's rent for leases of 12 months or less. Leases longer than 12 months require a security deposit of two months' rent. The deposit is refundable within 30 days of lease termination, less any documented charges for damages beyond normal wear and tear, unpaid rent, or unpaid utilities. An itemized accounting of any deductions will be provided. Interest is not paid on security deposits except where required by state law.

4. Lease Terms and Renewals

Standard lease terms are 12, 24, or 36 months. The expiration date is stated on the signed lease. Renewal notices must be issued by the landlord no later than 60 days before the lease end date. Tenants intending to vacate must provide written notice no later than 30 days before the lease ends; failure to provide timely notice converts the lease to month-to-month at a 10% rent premium.

5. Pets

Pets are permitted only when explicitly listed in the lease and accompanied by an additional pet deposit of \$300 per pet, non-refundable. Maximum two pets per unit. Dogs of restricted breeds (Pit Bull, Rottweiler, Doberman, Akita) require additional liability insurance. Service and support animals are not subject to the pet deposit, but documentation is required at lease signing.

6. Maintenance and Repairs

Tenants must report maintenance issues within 24 hours of discovery. Non-emergency repairs are addressed within 5 business days. Emergency repairs (loss of water, heat, electricity, or unsafe conditions) are addressed within 24 hours. If the landlord fails to remedy a documented emergency within 30 days and the tenant is current on rent, the tenant may pursue remedies under state landlord-tenant law. Tenants are responsible for routine items: replacing light bulbs, smoke-detector batteries, and minor clogs in sinks or toilets.

7. Utilities

Unless otherwise stated in the lease, the tenant is responsible for electric, gas, internet, and cable in their unit. Water and trash are included in the rent at multi-unit buildings; single-family rentals require tenant to maintain water/trash service in their name.

8. Move-Out and Final Inspection

A move-out inspection is conducted within 3 days of vacating. The tenant may attend by request. Damages beyond ordinary wear and tear (e.g., unfilled holes larger than a nail, stained or damaged carpet, broken fixtures,

unauthorized paint colors) are deducted from the security deposit at the vendor's invoiced cost. Cleaning charges apply only if the unit is not returned in broom-clean condition.

9. Privacy and Records

Tenant personal information (contact details, lease terms, payment history) is stored only as required for lease administration, dispute resolution, and legal compliance. Records are retained for seven years following lease termination. Information is not shared with third parties except as required by court order or applicable law.

10. Contact

Property management office hours are Mon-Fri, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM. Emergency maintenance is available 24/7 via the published emergency line. Written notices (lease changes, complaints, requests) must be submitted in writing via email or certified mail to be effective.